



Edie the Garden Fairy

Special thanks to Narinder Dhami

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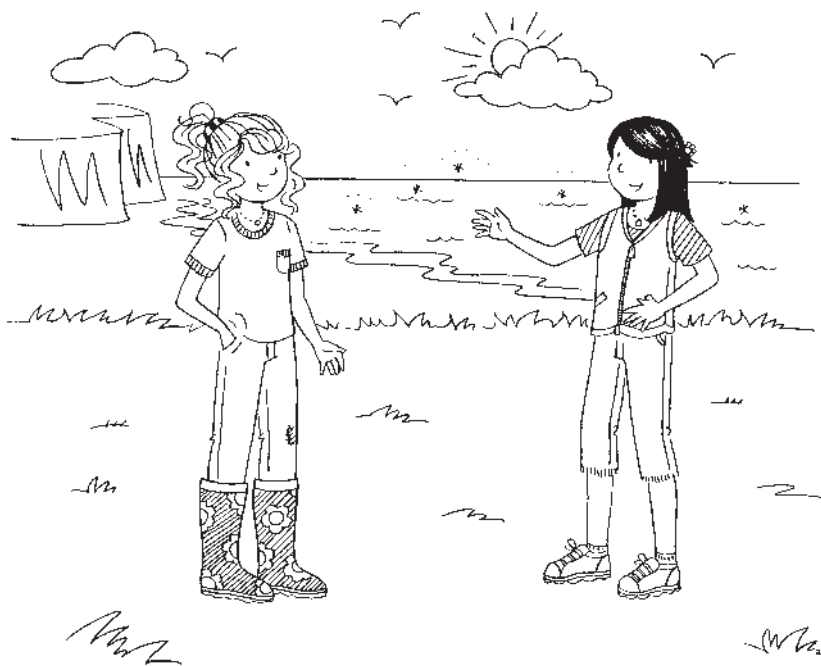


“It’s another beautiful day, Kirsty!” Rachel Walker exclaimed happily as she and her best friend, Kirsty Tate, hurried along the winding country lane. The blue sky above them was dotted with fluffy white clouds, and the sun was warm on their faces. “Isn’t Rainspell Island just the most *magical* place?”





“I can’t think of anywhere I’d rather go on vacation,” Kirsty replied, gazing over the lush green fields. The aquamarine sea sparkled in the distance and seagulls wheeled through the crisp, salty air.





The Tates and the Walkers had arrived on the island three days ago to spend the fall break there.

“It’s great that we’re helping to keep Rainspell clean and beautiful, isn’t it, Rachel?” Kirsty added. “Do you have the flyer that came yesterday?”

Rachel pulled the flyer out of her pocket. PROJECT GREEN was written at the top, and underneath it read:



Would YOU like to help the Rainspell Gardening Club make a NEW garden out of an area of unused land? Then please join us at our site on Butterfly Lane tomorrow. Wear old clothes!





“I’m glad we decided to volunteer,” Kirsty said as they studied the flyer. “We might have our friends the Earth Fairies to help us with the environment, but we humans have to do our part, too!”

Rachel nodded.



Rainspell Island was a very special place because it was where she and Kirsty had first become good friends with the fairies. Since then, the girls had shared many magical, amazing adventures while helping the fairies outwit cold, sly Jack Frost and his goblins.





But now it was Rachel and Kirsty's turn to ask the fairies for help. When the girls had arrived on Rainspell Island, they'd been shocked to see lots of litter scattered across the golden beach. They decided to ask the king and queen of Fairyland to help clean up the human world with fairy magic. King Oberon and Queen Titania had decided that the seven fairies currently in training would become the Earth Fairies. These fairies would help Rachel and Kirsty make the world a greener place. If the Earth Fairies were successful, they would become full-fledged, permanent fairies.

But just as the Fairyland Wand Ceremony was about to begin, the goblins stole the wands that were supposed to be given to the Earth Fairies.





Then Jack Frost's icy spell had immediately sent the goblins and wands spinning into the human world to hide. Jack Frost absolutely refused to help the world become greener, but Rachel and Kirsty were equally determined to make sure all seven of the Earth Fairies got their wands back from the goblins. Then they would work together to make the world become a cleaner, greener place.

“We made a good start,” Rachel said cheerfully. “We already tracked down Nicole the Beach Fairy’s wand, and Isabella the Air Fairy’s, too.”



“But it’s a little scary to think that there are *five* more goblins running around with fairy wands!” Kirsty frowned. “I hope we find them soon, so the Earth Fairies can get back to work cleaning up our world.”



“Remember what Queen Titania said though,” Rachel reminded her. “Fairy magic isn’t powerful enough to fix all the problems of the environment on its own. Humans have to help, too!”

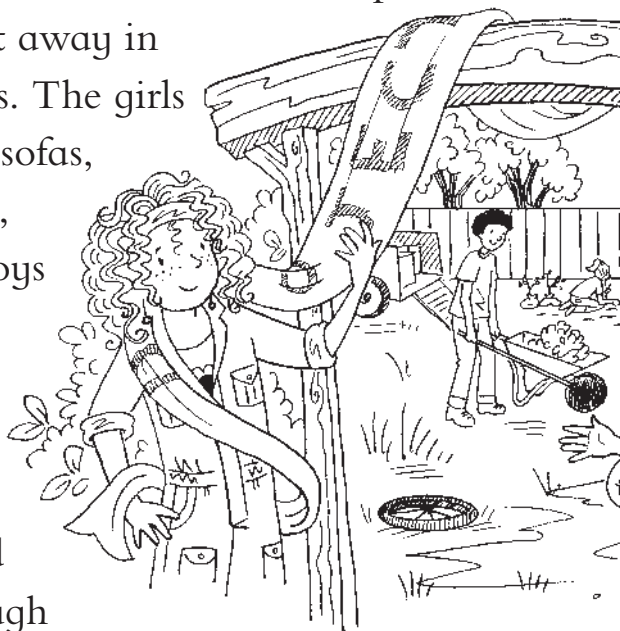
“I know.” Kirsty nodded. “We must be very close to the PROJECT GREEN area now, Rachel,” she said, looking around.

The girls kept walking. At the end of





Butterfly Lane they came to a large, empty lot. Rachel and Kirsty could see several people at work. Some were collecting trash that had been dumped and carting it away in wheelbarrows. The girls could see old sofas, rusty bicycles, and broken toys among the junk. Some volunteers were pulling up weeds and digging through the soil. Meanwhile, others were unloading tools and plants from the backs of trucks.



“There’s a lot to do,” Rachel whispered



to Kirsty. “This doesn’t look like a garden at all, yet!”

As the girls drew closer, they saw a woman in overalls carrying a long silver

banner that had PROJECT

GREEN printed on it in

tall emerald-green

letters. The woman

began trying to

hang the banner

over a big wooden

arch at the entrance

of the lot, but it was

so long that she got

tangled up in it. Rachel

and Kirsty rushed to help.

“Oh, thank you!” the woman said breathlessly as the girls helped her. Soon, they had draped the banner over the





arch. “Have you come to volunteer?”

The girls nodded eagerly. “I’m Rachel and this is my friend Kirsty,” Rachel explained.

“Fantastic!”

The woman smiled at them.

“My name’s Janet, and I’m the head volunteer. It’s really important that we get the garden set up as soon as possible because” — Janet glanced anxiously at her watch — “in a very short time, the builders and their bulldozers are arriving to turn this space into a parking lot!”

“That’s terrible!” Kirsty gasped.





“We’ve been learning at school how important green spaces are,” Rachel added.

“Yes, we need parks for people to enjoy, not more *parking* lots!” Janet said firmly. “The only person with the power to stop the builders is the mayor of Rainspell Island himself. We explained to the mayor that we want to show him how this space would work well as a garden — and he’s promised to come by in an hour to see for himself.”

“Only an hour!” Rachel exclaimed.

“That doesn’t give us much time.”





“How can we help?” asked Kirsty.

“See the fields around the vacant lot?”

Janet pointed at the fields that bordered the land on two sides.

“You can dig holes and plant saplings around the edges of the garden.

Then, when the trees have grown, they’ll help protect the space

from wind and rain. Come on, I’ll find some shovels for you.”

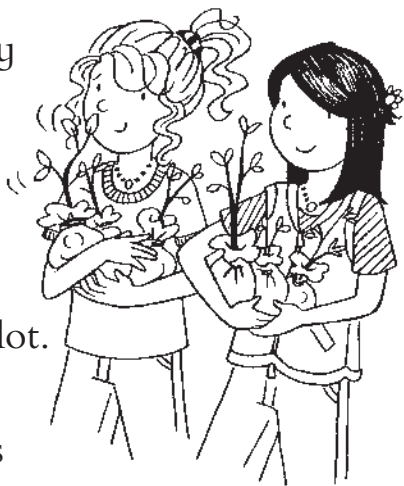


Rachel and Kirsty followed Janet across the lot. More volunteers were arriving all the time, and there was a buzz of activity as everyone got to work.



“Start over there at the corner of the field, and make sure you space the holes evenly,” Janet told the girls as she handed each of them a shovel. “Here are the saplings. We have oak, beech, and ash. If you have any problems, come and find me.” With a quick smile, Janet dashed off to welcome a new group of volunteers.

Rachel and Kirsty each collected an armload of tiny saplings and then headed toward the edge of the vacant lot. Suddenly, the saplings in Rachel’s arms began to tremble slightly and tickle her nose. Rachel gasped.





She really wanted to scratch the tip of her nose, but her arms were full.

“Oh, Kirsty, help!” she called. “The saplings are tickling my nose. I think I’m going to sneeze, and then I might drop everything!”

Kirsty immediately put down her own saplings and hurried over to Rachel. Her friend was twitching her nose in a desperate effort to keep from sneezing. Quickly, Kirsty took the saplings from Rachel’s arms. She looked closely at the tiny trees, and then gave a cry of delight.

“Oh, that’s better!” Rachel sighed with relief, rubbing her nose vigorously. “But why were the saplings shaking like that, Kirsty?”

Kirsty laughed. “Try and guess!”





“Is there a spider or a bee hiding in there?” asked Rachel.

“No, but we *have* seen these creatures before, and they have shimmery wings!” Kirsty replied, her eyes twinkling.

“A butterfly?” Rachel guessed.

“We *are* on Butterfly Lane, after all.”

Kirsty shook her head. She set the saplings on the ground and motioned for Rachel to look more closely. Once again the saplings quivered and trembled—and then a glittery fairy fluttered out of the branches!

